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# Chilkoor Balaji Temple

**Chilkur Balaji Temple** is an ancient Hindu temple of Lord Balaji on the banks of Osman Sagar in Rangareddy District in Telangana. It is one of the oldest temples in the Hyderabad Dist earlier now in Rangareddy Dist, built during the time of Madanna and Akkanna, the uncles of Bhakta Ramadas.[1]

C.S. Rangarajan is the current head priest of the Chilkur Balaji Devasthanam.[2] The temple has no hundi and does not accept any money from devotees.[3] The temple also has no green channel or privileges for VIPs.[4] The only other such Hindu temples are the Jalaram temple in Virpur (Rajkot), Gujarat and "Ramanuj Kot", a temple in Jodhpur, Rajasthan.[1] This temple fought and won the right to stay out of government control.[3]

| Chilkur Balaji Temple | |
|---|---|
| | |
| **Religion** | |
| **Affiliation** | Hinduism |
| **Deity** | Lord Venkateswara |
| **Location** | |
| **Location** | Chilkur Village, Gandipet, Ranga Reddy District, Telangana |
| **State** | Telangana |
| **Country** | India |
| | |
| Shown within Hyderabad | |
| **Coordinates** | 17°21′30″N 78°17′55″E |
| **Architecture** | |
| **Completed** | 14th century |
| **Website** | |

## Circumambulations

During a visit the devotee goes through the usual rituals of prayer, including 11 circumambulations of the inner shrine, and makes a vow. Once the wish is fulfilled devotees then walk 108 times around the sanctum sanctorum. The majority of wishes by devotees are visa related, thus Chilkur Balaji is also referred to as 'Visa' Balaji.[5][6]

## References


1. "Chilkur temple weaves dress code" (https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/hyderabad/Chilkur-temple-weaves-dress-code/articleshow/2872372.cms). *The Times of India*. Times News Network. 17 March 2008. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20121023160003/http://articles.timesofindia.indiatimes.com/2008-03-17/hyderabad/27761334_1_dress-code-temple-premises-first-temple) from the original on 23 October 2012. Retrieved 31 October 2012.

2. India, The Hans (1 September 2021). "Chilkur chief priest seeks PM's help to protect Hindu beliefs in Tamil Nadu" (https://www.thehansindia.com/news/cities/hyderabad/chilkur-chief-priest-seeks-pms-help-to-protect-hindu-beliefs-in-tamil-nadu-704400). *www.thehansindia.com*. Retrieved 11 April 2024.
3. "Telangana / Hyderabad News : Autonomy granted to Chilkur Balaji temple" (https://web.archive.org/web/20080405183903/http://www.hindu.com/2008/03/04/stories/2008030458260400.htm). *The Hindu*. 4 March 2008. Archived from the original (http://www.hindu.com/2008/03/04/stories/2008030458260400.htm) on 5 April 2008. Retrieved 31 October 2012.
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5. Visa Temple (https://web.archive.org/web/20121023155921/http://articles.timesofindia.indiatimes.com/2006-03-30/edit-page/27820132_1_visa-interview-balaji-temple-consulate), *The Times of India*, by Vamsee Juluri, 30 March 2006
6. MacRae, Penelope (3 February 2025). "Indians flock to Hindu temples to pray for US visas after Trump crackdown" (https://www.theguardian.com/world/2025/feb/03/indians-flock-to-hindu-temples-to-pray-for-us-visas-after-trump-crackdown). *The Guardian*.

chilkurbalaji.com (http://www.chilkurbalaji.com/)

Gopuram at Chilkur Temple

## External links

- Official site (http://www.chilkurbalaji.com/)
- Chilukur Balaji Temple (https://templeknowledge.com/about-chilkur-balaji-temple/)
- Chilkur Balaji Temple Timings (https://1temples.com/chilkur-balaji)
- Chilkur Balaji Temple Information (https://www.hyderabadzone.com/attractions/chilkur-balaji-temple/chilkur-balaji-temple.html)

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